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SUPPLY AND DEMAND FOR EARLY CARE IN NORTH MINNEAPOLIS

A 2015 Update

Supply and Demand for Early Care and Education Services in North Minneapolis: Analyses of Current Capacity and Use of School-Based Early Education and Family and Center-Based Child Care Programs in Zip Codes 55411 and 55412

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Author's Note

This report was produced by Kevin Overson and Scott McConnell.

The team at CEED@UROC shares the ongoing commitment by the University of Minnesota to engage in the communities we serve; the University has "always shared its knowledge, the fruits of its discoveries, and the talents of its faculty, staff, and students with the communities it exists to serve." Many in the community and in the state are working to expand capacity to provide access to high-quality early care and education settings for young children living in North Minneapolis.

The authors gratefully acknowledge the assistance of Rob Grunewald of the Federal Reserve Bank, Karin Maida of the Northside Achievement Zone, Sandy Myers of Think Small, and Maureen Seiwert of Minneapolis Public Schools, and the many contributing program leaders for the time and information on the data reporting used in this report.

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This report updates information provided in the spring of 2013 to describe the current supply and demand for early childhood care and education in North Minneapolis. We hope this information will be useful to program managers, policy makers, and advocates in considering the current state of access and quality in early care and education in North Minneapolis, and will serve as the basis for further data gathering, planning, and action.

With foundational skills developing, and educational disparities first appearing, by age 5, the early years are crucial. Unfortunately, many children do not have access to early learning that has the potential to set them on a successful path.

Providing high-quality learning experiences is a cost-effective means to positively impact children's development and achievements over both the short and long term. It's a proven tool we can use to diminish racial and other disparities in student achievement – and a resource that the State of Minnesota is working hard to provide to its young citizens.

Kevin Overson and Scott McConnell from CEED@UROC worked on this effort, gathering and organizing information from several different sources. In spring 2013 and fall 2014, to describe the "supply" of early care and education settings, we gathered information from Think Small, Minneapolis Public Schools, U.S. Census data, and direct queries to school-based and child care programs (including center- and family-based programs) in and around zip codes 55411 and 55412 (two zip codes that cover much of North Minneapolis). These data include programs that are licensed and rated in Parent Aware (Minnesota's Quality Rating and Improvement System) and those licensed child care centers and family child care providers not participating in Parent Aware. We were not able to gather information on Family Friend and Neighbor providers ("legal unlicensed" child care arrangements) in this area, but such providers are not currently eligible to receive ECD Scholarships, and thus are somewhat outside the broad intent of this analysis.

Next, we gathered information (with the assistance of Rob Grunewald from The Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis) to estimate the number of three- to four-year-old children living in this area who might be eligible to receive scholarship support to attend high-quality ECD settings. As part of this 'demand' analysis, we also gathered information from the Northside Achievement Zone regarding currently-enrolled children, and those currently receiving scholarship assistance.

Homeless and Highly Mobile Children

This year we provide estimates of the number of homeless and highly mobile (HHM) children enrolled in these identified care centers. While there is an "official" definition for what constitutes homelessness and high mobility (McKinney-Vento Homeless Assistance Act defines homelessness as children and youth "who lack a fixed, regular, and adequate nighttime residence"), we simply asked the question, "Do you know if there are any preschool children enrolled in your center that you would define as homeless or highly mobile?" Numbers reported here, we believe, under-estimate the actual number of homeless and highly mobile children who live in North Minneapolis – not through disinformation, but because several centers do not make this determination of the families and children they serve, and many simply did not know.

Supply

To estimate the potential supply of early childhood program services, and provide information that may be useful in organizing efforts to expand supply by improving quality ratings for already-operating early education programs, we have estimated the number of programs and possible "slots" for preschool children in two North Minneapolis zip codes (55411 and 55412). As with any reports on child care and early education capacity, these data are quite dynamic, meaning that numbers may well have changed from the time reports were generated, or programs may have changed status in that same interval.

Table 1 presents a summary of data provided by Sandy Myers of Think Small, compiled from the NACCRRAWare (a data base maintained by Think Small and updated regularly) on programs and possible number of slots at each; from Maureen Seiwert at Minneapolis Public Schools; and directly from providers.

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Program Type	Program Count	Total Slots Possible	Currently Available Slots	HHM Count
Parent Aware APR School Readiness Programs	9	420	2	42
Parent Aware APR Head Start Programs	1	300*	n/a	n/a
Parent Aware APR Child Care Programs	3	152	4	n/a
Parent Aware 4-star	10	226	48*	0*
Parent Aware 2-star	3	51	15	4
Parent Aware 1-star	4	36	13*	0*
Parent Aware Rating, Participating/In Progress	8	72	8*	3*
Licensed Center, NOT in Parent Aware	8	214	24*	26*
Licensed Family Childcare, NOT in Parent Aware	28	177	39*	9*
Total	74	1,648	153*	84*

Table 1. Early Care and Education Supply in North Minneapolis – Programs, Total Licensed Capacity and Currently Available Slots, and Homeless and Highly Mobile children, by Program Type and Parent Aware Rating.

NOTE: Data from NACCRRAware, provided by Sandy Myers, Think Small, retrieved on 11/6/2014; Maureen Seiwert, Minneapolis Public Schools, retrieved on 11/4/2014; and providers during calls made to each organization the week of November 1. Currently available slots and HHM numbers could only be obtained via direct response from the program.

We tried to contact each licensed program, but were unable to reach 30 of the listed programs. Numbers above followed by "" indicate incomplete numbers for currently available slots and number of HHM children in care.*

Additionally, several care locations may no longer be in operation; 9 programs representing 82 spaces for care had phone numbers no longer in service or disconnected. Because they reported at the last NACCRAware survey, we have included them here, but these results indicate the constantly changing landscape of this field.

- These supply data have also been presented on a map. That map can be found at: https://www.batchgeo.com/map/NMPLSEarlyCareData

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Demand

To describe demand, we relied on estimates of the number of income-eligible children likely to be living in the two focal zip codes, with the assumption that these children would (based on current public policy and best practices) both benefit from enrollment in high-quality early care and education programs, and be eligible for one or more subsidies for access.

Rob Grunewald of the Federal Reserve Bank provided these estimates. Mr. Grunewald noted that estimates may be somewhat low, because they are based on surveys completed between 2007 and 2011 for last year's data, and 2008 and 2012 for current data, and the population may have grown since that time. He also has indicated that the U.S. Census Bureau, the source of these estimates, notes that there is a relatively large margin of error – between 25-50% error at the 90% confidence level – for these estimates.

Table 2 presents estimates for the total number of children 3-4 years old, and the number of children who may be eligible for access support to attend high-quality early care and education settings in or near 55411 and 55412; estimated Number of Children with Family Incomes below 100% and 185% of Federal Poverty Guidelines

	Number of Children	Percent Represented
All Children 3-4 Years		
2014	1,898	100
2013	1,553	100
Below 100% FPG		
2014	826	44%
2013	697	45%
Below 185% FPG		
2014	1,299	68%
2013	1,085	70%

Note: Estimates based on US Census data from American Community Surveys completed between 2007-2012.

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Finally, we estimated the number of children already enrolled in the Northside Achievement Zone who may be eligible for scholarships, and interested in accessing high-quality programs in or near our focal zip codes.

Table 3: NAZ-Enrolled Children 3 to 5 Years of Age, and Those Currently Receiving Scholarships to Attend High-Quality Early Childhood Programs

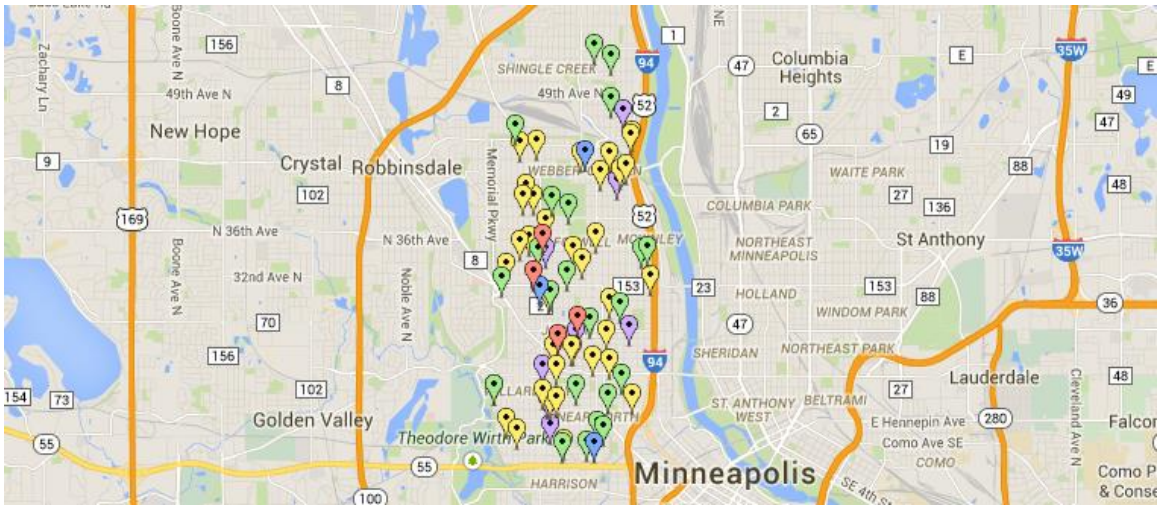
	Number of Children
NAZ-enrolled children 3-5 years of age	198
NAZ-enrolled children 3-5, currently using scholarships	66

Note: Data provided by Karin Maida, Northside Achievement Zone, 10/31/14

A Few Points to Ponder

- The most startling result of this effort was the discovery that, while "We don't have enough of a pattern established yet..., it appears we are losing total numbers of family child care providers through attrition in Minneapolis" (email correspondence with Sandy Myers, Director of Early Childhood Education, Think Small, November 24, 2014).
- There are nearly 1,900 3- and 4-year-olds in the 55411 and 55412 zip codes (about 18% more children than reported last year), and slots in 3- and 4-star-rated high quality early childhood programs for perhaps 58% of those.
- Approximately 10% of the children in care, no matter how we calculated it, were reported as homeless or highly mobile.
- Using zip codes 55411 and 55412 creates an artificial boundary, as children and families do in reality cross these boundaries.
- In addition to the incomplete numbers represented in Table 1, we found at least 3 programs that have closed, representing 36 slots. We believe this number may be low, but we also know of 2 programs starting that are so new that capacity is yet to be determined.
- Other special populations, such as children with disabilities and new immigrants/English-language learners, are not specifically addressed.
- The data is old as soon as it's gathered; a more frequent analysis might be useful. Additionally, a more detailed analysis of demographics by race, location, income, gender, home language, and mobility as well as a determination of quality of "family, friend and neighbor care" would be useful to pinpoint exactly where disparities appear and what contributing factors might exist.

Screen Print of Map of Supply, available at https://www.batchgeo.com/map/NMPLSEarlyCareData



(Locations reporting HHM children are not identified in order to protect the children's and families' confidentiality.)

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